

Day 95 — TNPSC Group 2A Study Material

Part A – General Studies: Current Affairs in TN History/Culture/Heritage (7): Tamil Nadu's 2026 National Para Athletics Performance

READING MATERIAL

Covers Tamil Nadu's performance at the National Para Athletics Championships 2026.

Q: Where did Tamil Nadu finish in the National Para Athletics Championships 2026 medal tally, and with how many total medals?

A: 2nd place, with 51 total medals (14 gold, 20 silver, 17 bronze).

Q: Which state topped the National Para Athletics Championships 2026 medal tally?

A: Haryana, with 39 gold medals.

Q: Which state finished 3rd in the National Para Athletics Championships 2026?

A: Gujarat.

Q: What financial incentive has the Tamil Nadu government separately announced for athletes?

A: Chief Minister M.K. Stalin announced a purse of ₹3 crore for Tamil Nadu sportspersons who win GOLD at the Olympics.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. Tamil Nadu finished at which position in the National Para Athletics Championships 2026?

- A. 1st
- B. 2nd ✓**
- C. 3rd
- D. 4th

Explanation: 2nd place. [medium, web-research]

2. Tamil Nadu won how many total medals at the National Para Athletics Championships 2026?

- A. 41
- B. 46
- C. 51 ✓**
- D. 56

Explanation: 51 (14 gold, 20 silver, 17 bronze). [hard, web-research]

3. Which state topped the National Para Athletics Championships 2026 medal tally?

- A. Tamil Nadu
- B. Haryana ✓**
- C. Gujarat
- D. Punjab

Explanation: Haryana (39 golds). [medium, web-research]

4. The Tamil Nadu government has announced a ₹3 crore purse for athletes who win:

- A. Any national medal
- B. Gold at the Olympics ✓**
- C. Gold at the Asian Games
- D. Any Para Athletics medal

Explanation: Gold at the Olympics. [medium, web-research]

Part B – Aptitude & Mental Ability: Alphanumeric Reasoning

READING MATERIAL

Alphanumeric Reasoning is 1 of 6 named Reasoning skills, combining letters and numbers in a single pattern. Real exam evidence (independently re-verified) shows three core techniques: letter-to-number position coding, variable-gap letter sequences, and fixed-shift word ciphers.

Q: Method — letter-to-number position coding: If ACEG is coded as 16, and DFGH is coded as 25, how would HIKM be coded?

A: Each letter is converted to its position in the alphabet (A=1, B=2, ... Z=26) and summed. ACEG: A=1, C=3, E=5, G=7, sum=16 ✓. DFGH: D=4, F=6, G=7, H=8, sum=25 ✓. Applying the same rule to HIKM: H=8, I=9, K=11, M=13, sum=8+9+11+13=41.

Q: Method — widening-gap letter sequence: Find the next letter: B, E, I, N, ?

A: Check the gaps between consecutive letters' positions: B(2)→E(5) is +3, E(5)→I(9) is +4, I(9)→N(14) is +5. The gap itself increases by 1 each time, so the next gap is +6: N(14)+6=20, which is T.

Q: Method — fixed-shift word coding (Caesar-cipher style): If ROAD is coded as URDG, how would SWAN be coded using the same rule?

A: Check the shift for each letter: R→U is +3, O→R is +3, A→D is +3, D→G is +3 — a uniform +3 shift applied to every letter. Applying the same +3 shift to SWAN: S→V, W→Z, A→D, N→Q, giving VZDQ.

Q: Method — two-interleaved-sequences letter pair: A pattern alternates first-letters increasing by a fixed gap and second-letters decreasing by the same gap (e.g., AZ, GT, MN, ?, YB). How do you solve it?

A: Track the two positions (first letter, second letter) as SEPARATE sequences. First letters: A(1), G(7), M(13) — increasing by 6 each time, so next is 19=S, then 25=Y (matches the given final term Y). Second letters: Z(26), T(20), N(14) — decreasing by 6 each time, so next is 8=H, then 2=B (matches the given final term B). So the missing term is S+H = 'SH'.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. If BDFH is coded as 20 (sum of letter positions), what would CEGI be coded as using the same rule?

- A. 22
- B. 24 ✓**
- C. 26
- D. 28

Explanation: C=3, E=5, G=7, I=9, sum=24. (Check rule: B=2, D=4, F=6, H=8, sum=20 ✓ matches given.) [medium, authored]

2. Find the next letter in the sequence: C, F, J, O, ?

- A. S
- B. T
- C. U ✓**
- D. V

Explanation: Gaps: C(3)→F(6) is +3, F(6)→J(10) is +4, J(10)→O(15) is +5, so next gap is +6: O(15)+6=21=U. [medium, authored]

3. If PLAN is coded as SODQ using a fixed letter shift, how would TRIM be coded using the same rule?

- A. WULP ✓**
- B. WUKP
- C. VULP
- D. WULO

Explanation: Shift check: P→S, L→O, A→D, N→Q — a uniform +3 shift. Applying +3 to TRIM: T→W, R→U, I→L, M→P, giving WULP. [hard, authored]

4. In the sequence DY, IT, NO, ?, XE, the first letters increase and second letters decrease by a fixed gap. What is the missing term?

- A. SJ ✓**
- B. SI
- C. TJ
- D. RJ

Explanation: First letters: D(4), I(9), N(14) — gap +5, so next is 19=S, then 24=X (matches given X). Second letters: Y(25), T(20), O(15) — gap -5, so next is 10=J, then 5=E (matches given E). Missing term: SJ. [hard, authored]

Part C – General English: Poem: "Leisure" — William Henry Davies

READING MATERIAL

A short sonnet protesting how modern busyness leaves no time to appreciate nature and life. Real coaching-site evidence tests theme, the poem's central complaint, and a couple of specific figures of speech.

Q: Who wrote "Leisure", and where/when was it first published?

A: William Henry Davies, in his 1911 collection Songs of Joy and Others.

Q: What is the central theme and complaint of the poem?

A: Nature and awareness — the poet protests modern life's busyness, arguing that people have lost the time (and the habit) to simply 'stand and stare' at the natural world around them.

Q: What does the repeated line "No time to stand and stare" emphasize?

A: A lack of awareness — people are too busy to notice or appreciate the world around them.

Q: What is the poem's structure and rhyme scheme?

A: A 14-line sonnet, with rhyme scheme AABCCDDEEFFGG (rhyming couplets throughout, rather than a traditional Shakespearean or Petrarchan sonnet rhyme pattern).

Q: Identify the figure of speech: "Streams full of stars, like skies at night."

A: Simile — directly compares the streams (reflecting stars) to night skies, using 'like'.

Q: Identify the figure of speech: "What is this life if, full of care, / We have no time to stand and stare?"

A: Rhetorical question — posed for emphasis, not expecting a literal answer; it's the poem's opening and central provocation.

Q: What was distinctive about William Henry Davies' own life, relevant to this poem's theme?

A: He lived as a self-described 'super-tramp', deliberately rejecting conventional steady employment in favour of a wandering, leisure-prioritizing lifestyle — directly embodying the poem's own argument.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. "Leisure" was written by:

A. William Blake

B. W. H. Davies ✓

C. Robert Frost

D. John Keats

Explanation: William Henry Davies. [easy, web-research]

2. The central theme of "Leisure" is:

A. Technology and speed

B. Nature and awareness ✓

C. Anger and injustice

D. Loneliness

Explanation: Nature and awareness. [easy, web-research]

3. What does the poet criticize about modern lifestyle in this poem?

A. Over-eating

B. Excessive noise

C. Busyness and lack of leisure ✓

D. Travel and tourism

Explanation: Busyness and lack of leisure. [medium, web-research]

4. "Streams full of stars" uses which figure of speech?

A. Simile ✓

B. Metaphor

C. Personification

D. Alliteration

Explanation: Simile (compared to night skies using 'like'). [medium, web-research]

5. "What is this life if, full of care, we have no time to stand and stare?" is an example of:

A. Alliteration

B. Irony

C. Hyperbole

D. Rhetorical question ✓

Explanation: Rhetorical question. [medium, web-research]

6. "Leisure" is structured as:

A. A 14-line sonnet with rhyming couplets ✓

B. A 4-stanza ballad

C. Free verse with no rhyme

D. A limerick

Explanation: A 14-line sonnet, rhyme scheme AABBCDDEEFFGG. [hard, web-research]